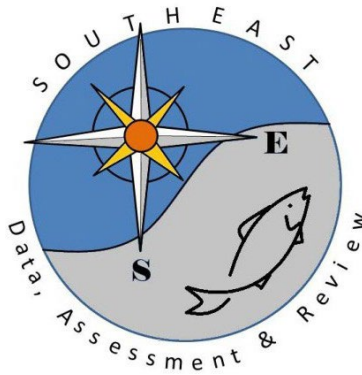




SEDAR

Southeast Data, Assessment, and Review

SEDAR 91

US Caribbean Spiny Lobster

SECTION IV: Research Recommendations

SEDAR
4055 Faber Place Drive, Suite 201
North Charleston, SC 29405

Puerto Rico**1. DATA WORKSHOP RESEARCH RECOMMENDATIONS**

- When developing new research projects, consider how those projects can be designed to include data collection and/or analyses that would inform ecosystem models and analyses. The original objectives of the project should not be compromised, however.

1.1 LIFE HISTORY RESEARCH RECOMMENDATIONS

- Life history studies focused on the US Caribbean – generate region-specific parameters for growth, fecundity, natural mortality.
- Look for ongoing growth/aging work via SEAMAP-C and DNER who is involved in doing histology for reproductive analyses.
- Merge selectivity studies, life history data collection, and fishery-independent survey frameworks to determine how to get best data for stock assessment.

1.2 COMMERCIAL FISHERY STATISTICS RESEARCH RECOMMENDATIONS**1.2.1 Length Composition Research Recommendations**

- Compare SEAMAP-C, HJR Reefscaping, and MER Consultants CL composition to TIP size composition.

1.2.2 Commercial Landings Research Recommendations

- - Track number of fishers/year in relation to annual landings- how does it vary?
- Support connectivity studies – consider spiny lobster as one stock vs. by island (metapopulation).
- Investigate weak/lack of correlation between TIP and landings data
- Demand analysis: look at price per pound (survey), market preferences, trends and correlation with landings, and for all islands.
- Investigate species associations with spiny lobster.
- Investigate recruitment connectivity between island platforms; e.g., STX seeding PR and other “hypotheses”.
- Increase funding for port samplers to improve TIP data collection in PR.
- Increase IT support for automated expansion factors calculation for the landings.

1.3 DISCARDS AND DISCARD MORTALITY RESEARCH RECOMMENDATIONS

- Discard information in the catch reports does not allow data on length or sex in current reporting schema.

1.4 RECREATIONAL FISHERY STATISTICS RESEARCH RECOMMENDATIONS

No research recommendations were provided.

1.5 MEASURES OF POPULATION ABUNDANCE RESEARCH RECOMMENDATIONS

- There were no recommendations from the panel regarding use of fishery-independent data in the Puerto Rico assessment model. However, the panel recommended that analysts not explore standardization of fishery-dependent data for use as an index of relative abundance.

2. ASSESSMENT PROCESS RESEARCH RECOMMENDATIONS

- Continue the SEAMAP-C and HJR Reefscaping data collection programs for collecting spiny lobster size composition data.
- Leverage sociological research to obtain information on the proportion of PR landings were caught in PR waters prior to 1985.
- Consider the use of management strategy evaluation to explore the uncertainty in non-commercial catches.

3. REVIEW PANEL RESEARCH RECOMMENDATIONS

The Review Workshop was cancelled so there were not review panel research recommendations compiled.

St. Croix

1. DATA WORKSHOP RESEARCH RECOMMENDATIONS

1.1 LIFE HISTORY RESEARCH RECOMMENDATIONS

- Life history studies focused on the US Caribbean – generate region-specific parameters for growth, fecundity, natural mortality.
- Look for ongoing growth/aging work via SEAMAP-C
- Merge selectivity studies, life history data collection, and fishery-independent survey frameworks to determine how to get best data for stock assessment.

1.2 COMMERCIAL FISHERY STATISTICS RESEARCH RECOMMENDATIONS

1.2.1 Length Composition Research Recommendations

- Compare SEAMAP-C to TIP size composition
Commercial Landings Research Recommendations
- Track number of fishers per year in relation to annual landings.
- Support connectivity studies – consider spiny lobster as one stock vs. by island (metapopulation).
- Investigate weak/lack of correlation between TIP and landings data
- Demand analysis: look at price per pound (survey), market preferences, trends and

- correlation with landings, and for all islands.
- Investigate recruitment connectivity between island platforms, e.g., STX seeding PR, and other “hypotheses.”
- Survey to determine the presence/absence of large lobsters in STX – are they available and not harvested? Market survey to determine whether the size of the lobster being landed is a response to the market preference/availability.
- Increase funding for port samplers to improve TIP data collection in PR and USVI.
- Propose new gear type of “diving on traps” in TIP reports (larger conversation to be had among those collecting and collating data):
 - a) Recommended this be a conversation including all jurisdictions,
 - b) Periodically review gears on forms to ensure they are accurate.

1.2.2 Discards and Discard Mortality Research Recommendations

- Discard information in the catch reports doesn’t include data on length or sex in current reporting schema

1.3 RECREATIONAL FISHERY STATISTICS RESEARCH RECOMMENDATIONS

No research recommendations were provided.

1.4 MEASURES OF POPULATION ABUNDANCE RESEARCH RECOMMENDATIONS

- The panel recommended moving forward with planned lobster trap surveys in the US Virgin Islands.

2. ASSESSMENT PROCESS RESEARCH RECOMMENDATIONS

- Continue the SEAMAP-C data collection program for collecting spiny lobster size composition data.
- Consider the use of management strategy evaluation to explore the uncertainty in non-commercial catches.

3. REVIEW PANEL RESEARCH RECOMMENDATIONS

The Review Workshop was cancelled so there were not review panel research recommendations compiled.

St. Thomas and St. John

1. DATA WORKSHOP RESEARCH RECOMMENDATIONS

-When developing new research projects, consider how those projects can be designed to include data collection and/or analyses that would inform ecosystem models and analyses. The original objectives of the project should not be compromised, however.

1.1 LIFE HISTORY RESEARCH RECOMMENDATIONS

- Life history studies focused on the US Caribbean – generate region-specific parameters for growth, fecundity, natural mortality.
- Look for ongoing growth/aging work via SEAMAP-C

- Merge selectivity studies, life history data collection, and fishery-independent survey frameworks to determine how to get best data for stock assessment

1.2 COMMERCIAL FISHERY STATISTICS RESEARCH RECOMMENDATIONS

1.2.1 Length Composition Research Recommendations

- Compare SEAMAP-C to TIP size composition to better inform gear selectivity.

1.2.2 Commercial Landings Research Recommendations

- Track number of fishers per year in relation to annual landings.
- Support connectivity studies consider spiny lobster as one stock vs. by island (metapopulation).
- Investigate weak/lack of correlation between TIP and landings data.
- Conduct a supplemental exploratory analysis to look at the STTJ trap CPUE in lbs./trap/hour.
- Investigate species associations with spiny lobster.
- Demand analysis: look at price per pound (survey), market preferences, trends and correlation with landings, and for all islands.
- Market survey to determine whether the size of the lobster being landed is a response to the market preference/availability.
- Increase funding for port samplers to improve TIP data collection in PR and USVI.
- Propose new gear type of “diving on traps” in TIP reports (larger conversation to be had among those collecting and collating data).
 - a) Recommended this be a conversation including all jurisdictions,
 - b) Periodically review gears on forms to ensure they are accurate

1.2.3 Discards and Discard Mortality Research Recommendations

- Discard information in the catch reports doesn’t include data on length or sex in current reporting schema

1.3 RECREATIONAL FISHERY STATISTICS RESEARCH RECOMMENDATIONS

No research recommendations were provided.

1.4 MEASURES OF POPULATION ABUNDANCE RESEARCH RECOMMENDATIONS

- The panel recommended moving forward with planned lobster trap surveys in the US Virgin Islands.

2. ASSESSMENT PROCESS RESEARCH RECOMMENDATIONS

- Continue the SEAMAP-C data collection program for collecting spiny lobster size composition data.
- Consider the use of management strategy evaluation to explore the uncertainty in non-commercial catches.

3. REVIEW PANEL RESEARCH RECOMMENDATIONS

The Review Workshop was cancelled so there were no review panel research recommendations compiled.